



“We have processed fixes for the top 100 open source repositories”

Nitish Shrivastava,
SVP and Head of Products Business at Persistent Systems

Persistent Systems aims to establish a world where every open source vulnerability has a service level agreement (SLA), so that enterprises can secure themselves against malevolent attacks without having to wait for community-driven fixes. *OSFY's Yashasvini Razdan* spoke to **Nitish Shrivastava**, SVP and Head of Products Business at Persistent Systems, about the company's mission to enhance open source security.

Q. Could you provide an overview of Persistent Systems' work in open source?

A. At Persistent, we recognise the significance of open source, both as contributors and consumers. Over the last few years, we have launched several solutions to enhance open source security. We have developed a green open source repository, which serves as an alternative for our customers. This ensures that they receive immediate fixes in compatible versions, helping them integrate updates seamlessly into their products.

Our Centre of Excellence (COE) for open source focuses on securing the entire open source supply chain. We have developed our own technology stack while also partnering with premium agencies. Our work includes identifying vulnerabilities, determining necessary paths for remediation, providing actual fixes, and making them available to the community. This ensures that enterprises receive timely solutions, keeping their systems secure.

We also offer a free service called Open Source Hub, available on our website. This allows developers to link their products and gain insights into potential vulnerabilities and remediation paths. The remediation process could involve applying an available fix, upgrading to a more secure version, or, if no solution exists, receiving a custom fix from us.

One of our key initiatives is DEVSource, a developer community designed to address security vulnerabilities in open source. We use generative artificial intelligence (AI) to automate code fixes, reducing the time required to resolve security issues with our proprietary platform SASVA.

Q. How do you ensure security in open source software?

A. We provide all the critical elements needed for managing open source security, including a software bill of materials (SBOM), which tracks dependencies down to multiple levels. We find vulnerabilities, plan a remediation

strategy, and fix issues—automating the entire process. What previously took companies up to two years, such as upgrading an appliance, can now be completed within a month. We also assess the geographical origins of open source components. Companies may need to evaluate potential security considerations based on the origin of components, in line with their standard risk management and compliance processes.

Q. How does providing vulnerability support generate revenue? In essence, what is your business model?

A. There are thousands of open source projects, and when vulnerabilities are discovered, our open source crew is among the first to provide fixes. These fixes are contributed back to the open source community and also made available in our green open source repository.

If you are a paying customer, you receive a timely fix in your specific version. For everyone else, the fix is freely available in the latest version through our